

Inspiration from an Ordinary Teacher

Vocabulary and Grammar Handout

Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

Inspiration from an Ordinary Teacher (A New Challenge, A Familiar Guide) An Unexpected Encounter

Two **months** ago, a young lady in a white blouse hurried into the teacher's office and bumped into me as I was returning to the classroom after handing in my homework. "Ah! I'm really sorry." She apologized to me after **discovering** that my projects were scattered all over the floor. "No..... It was my own carelessness for carrying too many **lectures** while walking." As I picked up the reports, I suddenly realized she didn't **seem** to be a teacher at my school. "I'm Lily, your new English teacher. Lovely to meet you!"

The Qualities of a Marvelous Teacher Include — Enthusiasm, Patience, and Responsibility

"Hey class, please take out your textbook." And so, every time the English class bell **rang**, our new teacher — Miss Lily — would rush into the classroom and hurriedly teach us English. Everyone seemed to have **gotten** used to this somewhat impetuous new teacher. Although Miss Lily was a bit clumsy and shy, she always added a touch of innocence to our English class, and she always **managed** to quietly ignite **students'** passion for English. Therefore, she is the most generous and responsible teacher I've ever seen!

Self-Control vs. Self-Limitation

Once, I was hesitating about whether to participate in the summer recreation camp or

not. I understood that it was really a great opportunity to train my autonomy, but perhaps that period **would** allow me to accomplish something more meaningful. While I sat in my seat and **spaced** out, a gentle voice **came**: “Follow your heart!” Miss Lily slowly approached me, her eyes resolute. “You feel hesitant because you don't want to risk ‘wasting time.’” She paused, her **gaze** gradually softening. “However, what if it doesn't waste your time, and even helps you break free **from** and transcend your **limitations.....?**”

That moment, I suddenly realized a significant truth: I want to make my time more efficient, but this isn't always good. **And** these **few** phrases from Lily have changed my thinking model, even helping me **conquer** and overcome countless difficulties and hurdles.....

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

Inspiration from an Ordinary Teacher (A New Challenge, A Familiar Guide) An Unexpected Encounter

Two months ago, a young lady in a white blouse rushed into the teacher's office and bumped right into me as I was heading back to my classroom after handing in my homework. "Ah! I'm really sorry," she apologized, glancing at my reports now scattered all over the floor. "No, no... it was my own carelessness for carrying too many papers while walking," I replied. As I knelt down to gather them, I suddenly noticed something strange — she didn't look like any of the teachers at our school. Then she smiled brightly and introduced herself: "I'm Lily, your new English teacher. Lovely to meet you!"

The Qualities of a Marvelous Teacher — Enthusiasm, Patience, and Responsibility

"Hey class, please take out your textbook!" From that day on, every time the English class bell rang, Miss Lily would dash into the classroom and dive straight into the lesson. Bit by bit, we all grew accustomed to this somewhat impetuous yet endearing new teacher. Although she could be a little clumsy and shy, she always brought a refreshing touch of innocence to our English class, quietly igniting our passion for the language without ever raising her voice. To me, she is by far the most warm-hearted and responsible teacher I have ever met.

Self-Control vs. Self-Limitation

One afternoon, I was wrestling with the question of whether or not to join the summer recreation camp. I knew it would be a wonderful chance to build my independence, yet a part of me wondered if that same stretch of time might be better spent on something

more meaningful. As I sat at my desk staring blankly into space, a gentle voice broke through my thoughts: “Follow your heart!” Miss Lily had quietly walked over, her eyes calm but resolute. “You feel hesitant because you're afraid of wasting time.” She paused, and her gaze softened. “But what if it doesn't waste your time at all — what if it actually helps you break free from your own limitations?”

In that single moment, a deeper truth dawned on me. I had always tried to make every minute more efficient, but I had never stopped to ask whether efficiency alone was truly worth chasing. Those few simple words from Miss Lily quietly reshaped the way I think — and even now, they continue to guide me through countless difficulties and hurdles whenever I feel stuck.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition	Example from Text
1	rush (v.)	to move or do something with great speed.	<i>"A young lady... rushed into the teacher's office."</i>
2	scattered (adj.)	spread out over a wide area in an irregular way.	<i>"My reports now scattered all over the floor."</i>
3	carelessness (n.)	failure to give enough attention or thought to what one is doing.	<i>"It was my own carelessness for carrying too many papers."</i>
4	gather (v.)	to bring things together into one place or group.	<i>"As I knelt down to gather them."</i>
5	dash (v.)	to run or move very quickly.	<i>"Miss Lily would dash into the classroom."</i>
6	accustomed (adj.)	familiar with something through experience or repetition.	<i>"We all grew accustomed to this... new teacher."</i>
7	impetuous (adj.)	acting quickly without thinking carefully.	<i>"This somewhat impetuous yet endearing new teacher."</i>
8	endearing (adj.)	causing affection or fondness; lovable.	<i>"Impetuous yet endearing new teacher."</i>
9	ignite (v.)	to set on fire; to arouse strong emotion or interest.	<i>"Quietly igniting our passion for the language."</i>
10	wrestle (v.)	to struggle mentally with a difficult problem or decision.	<i>"I was wrestling with the question of whether... to join the camp."</i>
11	independence (n.)	the ability to live or act without being controlled by others.	<i>"A wonderful chance to build my independence."</i>

#	Word	Definition	Example from Text
12	transcend (v.)	to rise above or go beyond a limit.	<i>“Helps you break free from... and transcend your limitations.”</i>

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. After being late so often, the manager grew tired of his employee's repeated ____.
a) carelessness b) independence c) embrace d) hurdle
2. Her speech managed to ____ a powerful sense of hope in everyone who listened.
a) gather b) ignite c) scatter d) transcend
3. He had to ____ across the platform to catch the train before it left.
a) gather b) wrestle c) dash d) ignite
4. Although she was tiny, her warm smile and kind nature were truly ____.
a) impetuous b) accustomed c) endearing d) scattered
5. After living in Tokyo for a year, he had become quite ____ to the busy lifestyle.
a) accustomed b) endearing c) impetuous d) scattered
6. Volunteers came together to ____ the trash that was spread across the beach.
a) ignite b) wrestle c) gather d) rush
7. Her decision to quit the job was rather ____ — she didn't think it through.
a) endearing b) accustomed c) impetuous d) scattered
8. Going to college far from home really helped me develop my ____.
a) carelessness b) independence c) limitation d) hesitation
9. Toys were ____ all over the living room after the children's birthday party.
a) gathered b) ignited c) accustomed d) scattered
10. I have been ____ with this math problem for an hour but still can't solve it.
a) wrestling b) dashing c) rushing d) gathering
11. A great novel can ____ time and culture, speaking to readers of any era.
a) gather b) transcend c) scatter d) wrestle
12. When the alarm went off, everyone began to ____ toward the nearest exit.
a) gather b) wrestle c) rush d) ignite

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blank

Fill in each blank with the correct vocabulary word. Change the form if necessary.

Word bank: rush / scattered / carelessness / gather / dash / accustomed / impetuous / endearing / ignite / wrestle / independence / transcend

1. The chef _____ all the fresh ingredients before starting to cook.
2. His _____ in answering the email caused him to miss the deadline.
3. The puppy's playful behavior was so _____ that everyone smiled.
4. Reading inspiring books helped _____ her passion for writing.
5. Don't make such an _____ choice — think about it overnight first.
6. Moving away from home taught me the value of true _____.
7. She had to _____ with her doubts before signing the contract.
8. Great art can _____ language and reach the heart of any viewer.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: "as + subject + past continuous" (background action)

Form: Main clause + as + subject + was/were + -ing

Use: To set up an ongoing action in the past during which another event happened.

Example from text: *"She bumped right into me as I was heading back to my classroom."*

More examples:

- The phone rang as I was taking a shower.
- We met for the first time as I was waiting for the bus.
- He dropped his keys as he was unlocking the door.

Pattern 2: "From that day on, ..." (time-marker opening)

Form: From that day on, + subject + verb...

Use: To signal that a new pattern or routine began at a specific past moment.

Example from text: *"From that day on, every time the English class bell rang, Miss Lily would dash into the classroom."*

More examples:

- From that day on, I never skipped breakfast again.
- From that day on, she practiced the piano for an hour every evening.
- From that day on, our friendship grew stronger.

Pattern 3: "adjective + yet + adjective" (concessive contrast)

Form: adjective + yet + adjective + noun

Use: To link two seemingly opposite qualities in a single description.

Example from text: *"This somewhat impetuous yet endearing new teacher."*

More examples:

- It was a simple yet powerful idea.
- She gave a quiet yet firm answer.
- He is a strict yet caring father.

Pattern 4: "What if + clause...?" (hypothetical question)

Form: What if + subject + verb...?

Use: To raise a hypothetical situation or invite reflection on a possibility.

Example from text: *"But what if it doesn't waste your time at all?"*

More examples:

- What if we miss the last train home?
- What if she said yes to your invitation?
- What if this is the chance you have been waiting for?

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the answer that best completes each sentence.

1. ____ I was crossing the street, a strong wind blew my hat away.
a) From b) As c) What d) Yet
2. It is a difficult ____ rewarding job to be a kindergarten teacher.
a) yet b) as c) what d) on
3. ____ if we leave an hour earlier so we can avoid the traffic?
a) As b) From c) What d) Yet
4. ____ that day on, he kept a journal every single night.
a) From b) What c) As d) Yet
5. She tripped on the carpet ____ she was carrying the heavy box.
a) yet b) as c) what d) from
6. What ____ the rumor turned out to be completely true?
a) as b) from c) yet d) if
7. He is a young ____ wise leader who listens to everyone's opinion.
a) as b) from c) yet d) what
8. From that ____ on, our morning walks became a daily routine.
a) as b) what c) yet d) day

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

as + past continuous

1. I was walking the dog. At that time, my friend called me. (...as I...)

as + past continuous

2. We were having dinner. The lights suddenly went out. (...as we...)

From that day on

3. After that day, he never told a lie again. (From that day on, ...)

From that day on

4. Since that morning, she always greeted her neighbors warmly. (From that day on, ...)

adjective + yet + adjective

5. The hike was tiring. It was also enjoyable. (...yet...)

adjective + yet + adjective

6. Her voice is soft. Her voice is also clear. (...yet...)

What if + clause

7. Maybe the train is late today. (What if...?)

What if + clause

8. Perhaps your idea will actually work. (What if...?)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. a 2. b 3. c 4. c 5. a 6. c 7. c 8. b 9. d 10. a 11. b 12. c

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blank

1. gathered
2. carelessness
3. endearing
4. ignited
5. impetuous
6. independence
7. wrestle
8. transcend

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b 2. a 3. c 4. a 5. b 6. d 7. c 8. d

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

1. I was walking the dog as my friend called me. / My friend called me as I was walking the dog.
2. The lights suddenly went out as we were having dinner.
3. From that day on, he never told a lie again.
4. From that day on, she always greeted her neighbors warmly.
5. The hike was tiring yet enjoyable.
6. Her voice is soft yet clear.
7. What if the train is late today?
8. What if your idea actually works?